

Participant Information Sheet

Study Title: Online Self-paced Reading Task in English

Principal Investigator: Takumi Kobayashi

Institution: University of Stuttgart, Institute of Linguistics

You are being invited to participate in a research study. Before you decide whether to take part, it is important for you to understand why the research is being done and what it will involve. Please take the time to read the following information carefully. Feel free to ask the researcher if there is anything that is unclear or if you would like more information.

1 What is the purpose of this study?

This research is part of a broader program investigating how people understand and produce language. The specific goal of this study is to investigate how readers process grammatically complex sentences in English. The findings will contribute to our scientific understanding of the cognitive processes underlying human language use.

2 Why have I been invited?

You have been invited because you meet the criteria for this study. These are: you are over 18 years of age and fluent in English.

3 What will I be asked to do?

If you agree to participate, you will be asked to perform a series of tasks. This will involve reading sentences presented on the screen. After each sentence, you will be asked a simple comprehension question.

The study is expected to last approximately 30 minutes.

4 Are there any risks or benefits to taking part?

The risks associated with this study are minimal and are not expected to exceed those encountered in everyday life. You may experience minor fatigue from concentrating on the tasks.

There are no direct benefits to you for participating. However, your participation will contribute to valuable scientific knowledge about human cognition and language.

5 Is my participation voluntary?

Your participation is entirely voluntary. You are free to withdraw from the study at any time, without giving a reason and without any negative consequences. If you choose to withdraw, you will still receive any promised compensation for the time you have participated. You can also request that any data collected from you up to that point be deleted.

6 Will I be compensated for my time?

You will receive payment at a rate of **EUR14 per hour** for your participation via Prolific. This payment is for your time and is not dependent on your performance in the tasks.

7 How will my data be handled and protected?

We are committed to protecting your privacy and will handle your data in accordance with the EU General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR).

- **Pseudonymization:** All research data we collect (e.g., your responses and reaction times) will be pseudonymized. This means that your name and other identifying information will be replaced with a unique participant code. The key linking your code to your personal information will be stored securely and separately from the research data.
- **Data storage and access:** Identifiable data (on paper or digital) will be stored in secure locations at University of Stuttgart. Access to identifiable personal data is restricted to the principal investigator and authorized members of the research team.
- **Open science and data sharing:** To promote scientific transparency and reproducibility, fully anonymized or pseudonymized research data from this study will be shared publicly in a data repository (such as the Open Science Framework) after the results have been published. The shared dataset will not contain any information that could be used to identify you.

8 Who should I contact for more information?

If you have any questions about the study, please contact: Takumi Kobayashi (takumikobayashi0304@gmail.com) or the Principal Investigator: Jun.-Prof. Dr. Titus von der Malsburg Email: titus.von-der-malsburg@ling.uni-stuttgart.de

If you have questions about your rights as a participant or wish to make a complaint, you can contact the Data Protection Officer of the University of Stuttgart: Email: datenschutz@uni-stuttgart.de

Thank you for taking the time to read this information sheet.